



Lost something? Start here.

Project overview & user guide

For Saint Louis University
Baguio City, Philippines

A clear, friendly walkthrough of reporting an item, finding a possible match, making a claim, and recording its return - on the web or in the iPhone preview.

A working prototype, with a few important limits

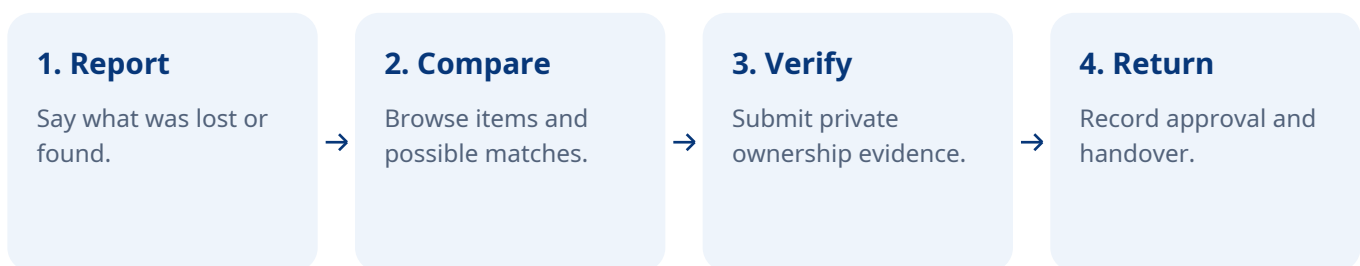
LouFind is an unofficial local demo. It is not an SLU service, and its sample accounts, reports, locations, and pickup instructions are for practice only.

What LouFind is here to do

A familiar campus problem, brought into one simple place.

You put down an umbrella between classes, or find a calculator someone has left behind. LouFind gives both people a way to describe the item, compare details, and follow what happens next.

The project is designed around **Saint Louis University in Baguio, Philippines**. Students and staff can report or claim items; a demo security role reviews the evidence and records the return. The real university is identified by its [official Philippine website](#); LouFind is not endorsed by or connected to its systems.



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Before you try it

The app is a local prototype. When it says a report is "live," that means published inside this browser's demo, not posted to a real university noticeboard. Use made-up information throughout.

Your first few minutes

Open the app, try a sample role, and follow one item all the way home.

If the website is already running, open **http://localhost:3000** on the Mac. A fresh demo opens as Jamie Santos. The LouFind loading screen appears while the app prepares its local data, then the Home screen opens. For first-time installation or iPhone access, go to page 10.

Choose a sample account

Use the sidebar's **Try a demo role**, or on mobile choose **More > Account & demo roles**. To sign in as Mika or try registration, open the account menu and select **Sign out / change account**.

Role	Name	Demo email	Sample ID
Student	Jamie Santos	jamie@slu.edu.ph	2024-01482
Student	Mika Reyes	mika@slu.edu.ph	2023-00836
Staff	Alex Rivera	alex@slu.edu.ph	ST-00124
Security	Officer Cruz	security@slu.edu.ph	SEC-0018

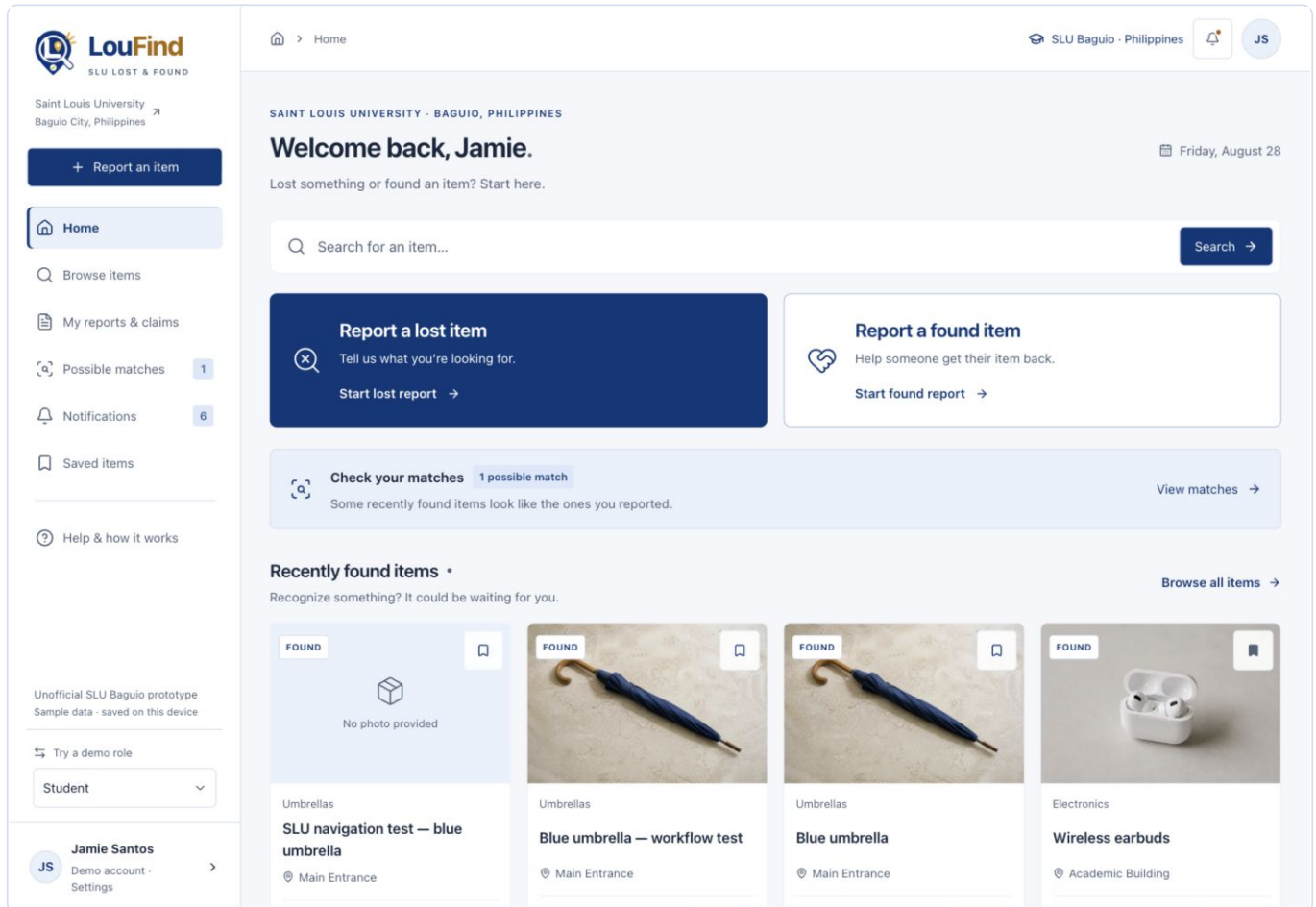
Demo password for every sample account: Campus123! These are fictional accounts. Do not use a real SLU password. Registration accepts a fabricated @slu.edu.ph address, but sends no verification email and does not check enrollment.

A short practice run

- 1 As Jamie, report a lost umbrella.**
Use "Practice blue umbrella," category Umbrellas, color Blue, and a sample location. Use today's date and keep a made-up identifying mark private.
- 2 Switch to Staff and report it found.**
As Alex, create a found report with the same item details, date and location. The reports must have different reporters to be considered a match.
- 3 Return to Student and claim the found report.**
Open it from Browse or Possible matches. Choose This might be mine, link Jamie's lost report, and supply the fictional mark and proof.
- 4 Switch to Campus security to finish the example.**
Review and approve the evidence, then record a simulated handover as Returned. Switch back to Jamie to see the update. Page 8 explains each control.

Find your way around

The same main actions are available on a laptop and a phone.



Desktop Home screen from the local prototype. Sample test records are visible; the image shows the layout, not real lost property.

On a phone, start with the bottom menu



Home brings you back to search and the two report actions. **Browse** opens all published items. **Report** starts a lost or found report. **My reports** holds your reports, claims, saved items and drafts.

More contains matches, notifications, saved items, help and account settings. It also shows the security dashboard when that demo role is selected. On desktop, these destinations sit in the left sidebar.

Need a way back? Use the main menu or your browser's Back button. Choose Help & how it works for the in-app explanation.

Report an item, step by step

A useful report is clear enough to recognize, with a few details kept private.

- 1

The item

Choose **I lost an item** or **I found an item**. Add an optional photo, a short title, a category and a color. "Blue umbrella with a wooden handle" is more helpful than "My stuff."
- 2

When & where

Write the public description, select the date, approximate time and campus location, and add the brand if you know it. Put unique marks in **Private identifying features**. Choose a contact preference; this demo records it but does not send external messages.
- 3

Review

Check the item type, description, date and place. Use **Back** to correct anything, then select **Submit report**. Keep the reference number so you can find the report again. Only a successful confirmation means the report was published in this local demo.

What should I write?

Public description	Private identifying features
"Folded blue umbrella with a curved wooden handle. Last seen near the library entrance."	"A small silver star sticker is hidden inside the handle."
Enough detail for someone to recognize the general item.	Details that help distinguish its owner from someone guessing from the photo.

Photos: helpful, but optional

Use JPG, PNG or WebP, up to 8 MB. Hide names, ID numbers and unique marks before adding a public photo. LouFind reduces image size to fit local storage; there is no built-in redaction tool. Wait for photo processing before continuing.

Need to finish later? Drafts save as you type. Look for "Draft saved on this device." The first step also has **Save draft**. Resume from **My reports & claims > Draft reports > Continue report**. Drafts are not published to Browse.

If the form will not continue: use at least 3 characters for the title and 15 for the description, complete the required selections, and choose today or an earlier date. Read the message next to the highlighted field.

Search first. Then compare.

You do not need a perfect description to start looking.

1 Open Browse and use a simple keyword.

Try "umbrella," "calculator" or a report reference. Search checks public item text, including the title, description, category, color and brand. Every word you enter must match somewhere in that text.

2 Narrow the list only as much as you need.

Choose Lost, Found or All; then filter by category, color, location, status or date range. Sort by newest, oldest or item name, and switch between grid and list views. If nothing appears, clear filters and try fewer words.

3 Open a promising item and read the details.

Compare when and where it was found, the description and the photo. Use **Save item** or the bookmark to come back later. A saved item is a bookmark, not an ownership claim or reservation.

What does a match percentage mean?

Possible matches compare lost and found reports using fixed rules. The same inputs give the same result. LouFind does not recognize objects in photos or use AI to decide ownership.

Compared information	Maximum points
Same category	30
Similar words in the title and public description	25
Same color or color family	15
Same location; a nearby zone scores less	15
Date proximity; closer dates score more	10
Matching brand, otherwise overlapping private features	5

A suggestion needs a score of at least 65, some shared public keywords, the same category and different reporters. The found date must be on or after the lost date and within 30 days. Draft, returned, rejected, unclaimed and pickup-ready reports are excluded.

A strong lead, not proof

An 85% match means the reports share several details. It does not mean there is an 85% chance the item is yours. Private evidence still needs review, and a match never releases an item automatically.

When something looks like yours

Explain the details only the owner would know, then follow the review.

Open an eligible **found** report and choose **This might be mine**. You cannot claim your own found report. If you already have an active claim, or the item is returned, pickup-ready, unclaimed or a draft, the claim action is unavailable.

Link your own lost report if you have one. Describe a unique mark or private detail, explain the proof you could provide, and optionally add a supporting image. In this demo, use invented evidence. Select **Submit private claim**; a successful submission becomes **Under Review**.

Check **My reports & claims > My claims** and **Notifications** for the decision. Read the review note. If a claim is rejected, you can submit a new one with stronger evidence. There is no automatic review or guaranteed response time.

Understand the labels

Status	What it means for you
Draft	A report is unfinished and saved locally. Continue it before expecting it in Browse.
Reported	A report has been published in the demo and can be browsed.
Possible Match	A report has a possible counterpart. Compare details; ownership is not established.
Under Review	A claim is awaiting a decision, or a report is in the review stage.
Ready for Pickup	A claim was approved. Read the note; final identity and handover checks still come next.
Returned	The demo security workflow has recorded the handover.
Rejected	The claim was not approved from the evidence supplied. Read the reason before trying again.
Unclaimed	A report has been marked unclaimed by the demo security role. This is not an official retention deadline.

Pickup is simulated. Office names or hours shown in sample claims are not verified SLU instructions. For real lost property, confirm the appropriate campus office and its current process through official university channels.

Review carefully. Close the loop.

This page explains the sample security role used to demonstrate the return process.

Choose **Campus security** in the desktop role switcher, or **Security - Officer Cruz** from the mobile account settings. The security dashboard opens. In a real service this access would be restricted to verified staff; the demo switcher is intentionally open for testing.

1 Review the ownership evidence.

In the claim queue, choose **Review evidence**. Compare the finder's private details with the claimant's marks, contents, proof and optional image. The claimant's sample identity and any recorded storage location are also available here.

2 Write the decision in plain language.

Fill in **Review note / pickup instructions**. To approve, confirm that you compared the private details and verified the evidence, then choose **Approve for pickup**. If the evidence does not support the claim, choose **Reject claim** and explain what was missing.

3 Record the item and its eventual return.

Open **All reports**, find the item and choose **Manage**. Record its **Private storage location**. After the approved claimant's ID check and handover have been simulated, select **Returned**, confirm the handover checkbox, then choose **Save changes**.

Approval and handover are separate steps

An item cannot be marked Returned before an ownership claim is approved. The prototype also prevents duplicate active claims and conflicting approvals for the same item. A high match score does not bypass these checks.

What changes after a return?

The found report and approved claim are updated, and the claimant gets an in-app notification. If the claimant explicitly linked their own lost report, that report is closed too. Other similar lost reports are not automatically closed.

The dashboard's counts and recovery rate are calculated from the demo records. The activity log records actions such as reviews, storage changes and returns. It helps explain the workflow, but is not a tamper-proof audit trail.

For a classroom presentation: follow the practice run on page 3 in one browser. Creating a new sample item avoids relying on a seeded calculator or umbrella that an earlier demo may already have returned.

Keep track without oversharing

Your reports should be easy to find, and your identifying details should stay out of public posts.

In My reports & claims	What you can do
My lost reports / My found reports	Open the reports you created and use the edit action on eligible own reports.
My claims	Read claim status, review notes and the linked item.
Saved items	Revisit bookmarked items; tap the bookmark again to remove one.
Draft reports	Continue an unfinished report, or delete the draft after confirming. Deletion cannot be undone.

Notifications show match, claim, pickup and return updates. Open them and mark them read. They stay inside LouFind; no email, text message or phone push notification is sent.

Where does everything go?

Your records use local browser storage. They usually survive a reload, but stay tied to the device, browser and website address you used.

Mac browser

Separate local records.

iPhone Safari

Separate local records.

Expo Go

Separate local records.

These stores do not sync. Even localhost and the Mac's Wi-Fi address use different stores. Sharing a link does not transfer a custom report. There is no cloud backup or built-in export/recovery feature.

Information	Who sees it in the interface
General item description, photo, date, place and status	People browsing published reports in that local demo.
Private identifying marks	The reporter and the security role.
Ownership evidence	Entered privately by the claimant; reviewed in the security workspace.
Exact storage location	The security workspace.

Keep real documents out of the demo

Browser access allows inspection of demo data. Reset demo data or clearing site data deletes local records, photos and accounts. There is no built-in recovery.

Open LouFind on your iPhone

For the iPhone 13 and iOS 26.2.1 preview, the Mac runs the app and the phone connects to it.

The **Expo Go** companion displays the existing website inside a native WebView. It is a local preview, not a LouFind App Store release.

On the Mac: first-time setup

Install Node.js 22.13 or newer and npm. Open Terminal in the LouFind project folder. If you need to navigate there on this Mac, run:

PROJECT FOLDER + DEPENDENCIES (ONCE)

```
cd "/Users/davidson/Desktop/LouFind"  
npm install  
npm --prefix mobile install
```

TERMINAL 1 - KEEP RUNNING

```
npm run dev:lan
```

TERMINAL 2 - KEEP RUNNING

```
npm run phone
```

Run both commands from the project folder. The phone command detects the Mac's local address and creates **outputs/loufind-expo-qr.png**. Open that image on the Mac so the iPhone can scan it.

On the iPhone

1 Install Expo Go.

[Get Expo Go from the App Store](#). The QR at the right opens its download page; it does not open LouFind.

2 Join the same trusted Wi-Fi.

Keep the Mac awake and both Terminal commands running. Allow Local Network access for Expo Go when prompted.

3 Scan the generated Expo QR on the Mac.

Use the iPhone Camera, then choose Open in Expo Go. You should reach LouFind's loading screen and Home screen.



APP STORE DOWNLOAD
Not the preview QR

Keep the preview address current

Rerun `npm run phone` after changing Wi-Fi. On the iPhone, localhost means the phone, not the Mac. This companion uses Expo SDK 54; see page 14 if Expo Go reports a version mismatch.

The iOS bundle and local connection were checked on the Mac. A successful launch, photo permissions and gestures on the physical iPhone still need a device-side check.

If something does not work

Start with the simplest check. Most preview problems are about the connection or local storage.

The phone cannot connect.

Keep both servers running, use the same trusted Wi-Fi and allow Expo Go Local Network access in Settings. Regenerate the QR after a network change. Guest or campus Wi-Fi may block device-to-device connections; try a trusted home network or personal hotspot.

Expo says the project is incompatible.

This companion uses SDK 54. Confirm the Expo Go client matches it, using Expo's guidance on page 14. Start `npm run phone` from the main LouFind folder. Do not install Expo into the parent web package or point it at the web app/ folder.

My phone has different reports.

That is expected: Mac browsers, Safari and Expo Go have separate data. Return to the original device, browser, address and sample account to find the same records. The demo has no cross-device synchronization.

A photo or draft will not save.

Use JPG, PNG or WebP below 8 MB and wait for processing. Try a smaller image if storage is full. Read any save error; do not assume it succeeded. A deleted draft or cleared browser store has no built-in recovery.

No matches, or no claim button.

Clear Browse filters and try fewer words. Matches need compatible dates, categories and different reporters. Claim only an eligible found report that someone else created; an existing active claim or closed item can hide the action.

The preview has not updated.

Reload the web interface. For changes inside mobile/, stop and restart `npm run phone`, then reopen the preview. Automatic native file watching is intentionally off in the current patched setup.

Can I add it to the Home Screen?

In Safari, open the reachable LouFind website, use **Share** (or More, then Share), choose **Add to Home Screen**, enable **Open as Web App** if offered, and tap Add. This is a separate option from Expo Go. See [Apple's instructions](#). Browser support and the site's HTTPS setup affect install features.

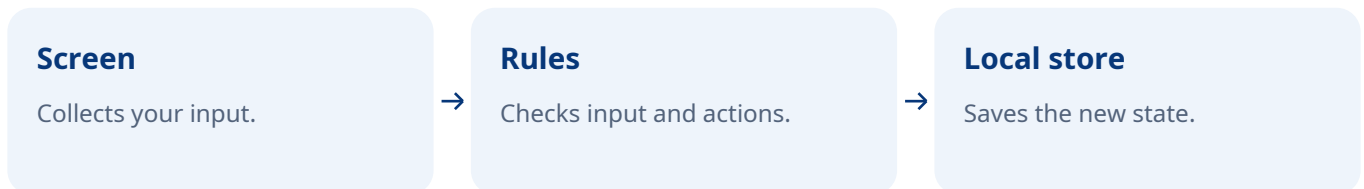
An icon is not an offline copy. The working interface still needs a connection to the server. The production service worker provides an offline information page, not a complete offline app. Real-device Home Screen installation has not yet been verified for this project.

Just want the website on your Mac?

With Node.js 22.13+ and npm installed, open the project folder and run **npm install** once, then **npm run dev**. Visit <http://localhost:3000>. No Expo setup is needed for this option.

How the project works

A short explanation for presenters, developers and anyone curious about what happens after a tap.



Valid changes update the saved state, recalculate matches and add in-app notifications. Reports and claims change status only when workflow checks pass. There is no shared school database in this demo.

Part	What it does
React 19 + TypeScript	Build the interactive screens with typed application data.
Vinext / Vite	Provide the Next App Router-style web structure and a Cloudflare-compatible build. This is not the stock next package.
Tailwind + Base UI / shadcn	Style the layout and provide interface controls; Lucide supplies icons.
React Hook Form + Zod	Track form fields and check required values before submission.
Expo SDK 54 + WebView	Load the same website in the iPhone companion, with native loading, retry and safe-area handling.
localStorage	Keep profiles, reports, claims, notifications, bookmarks and activity in a versioned browser document.

Where to look in the project

app/ sets up pages, loading and the theme. **components/** holds navigation and shared controls. **features/** holds the screens. **lib/** contains types, sample data, validation and persistence; **lib/services/** contains matching and workflow rules.

public/ contains images and install/offline assets. **mobile/** has separate Expo dependencies. **scripts/start-phone.mjs** starts the phone preview. **tests/** holds behavior checks and the verification record.

Demo authentication is not a production security boundary

Passwords use salted PBKDF2-SHA256 hashes, but accounts and role changes still live on the client. A production system must enforce identity, permissions and ownership rules on a trusted server.

What is ready, and what is next

A useful demo should be honest about both its working features and its remaining work.

Working in the current prototype

Reporting, photos, drafts, search, filters, matching, private claims, review decisions, handover, notifications and bookmarks work in the prototype. LouFind branding, responsive navigation, loading screens and the Expo phone preview are included.

Recorded checks - 28 August 2026

Checked	Recorded result
Automated behavior tests	25 passed, covering workflows, matching, storage behavior and phone-preview compatibility.
Web checks	Strict TypeScript, lint and the production build passed. Browser report, claim, review, return and draft flows were exercised.
Responsive layout	Browser layouts from 320 to 1440 pixels were checked during the branding work; no horizontal overflow was found on the tested screens.
Mobile build checks	Mobile TypeScript and iOS Hermes bundle export passed. Expo Doctor passed 18 checks; the local manifest and iOS bundle were served successfully.
Dependency audits	Both web and mobile packages reported zero known vulnerabilities at that check. This is not a guarantee of security.

These results come from **tests/VERIFICATION.md**. They are a dated project record, not a new test run performed while writing this guide.

Still needs real-world verification

Physical iPhone launch, photo permissions, gestures and Home Screen installation remain unverified. Manual screen-reader and keyboard checks are also pending. Larger controls, visible focus and reduced-motion support are implemented; accessibility is not certified.

Before real campus use

- 1. Agree on the service.** Confirm university approval, actual locations, pickup procedures and who is responsible for reports.
- 2. Add a trusted backend.** Implement real sign-in, server authorization, a shared database, private file storage and verified staff roles.
- 3. Protect and support users.** Define data retention, moderation, backups, recovery, privacy notices and notification delivery.
- 4. Test and release deliberately.** Complete security, accessibility and device testing before an authorized deployment.

Local preview only. No public deployment, shared backend or verified university accounts.

Keep this page handy

The guide follows the project as it exists on 28 August 2026. Software and device instructions may change later.

Project sources

The feature descriptions were checked against the project's **README.md**, **mobile/README.md**, **tests/VERIFICATION.md** and the implementation in **features/**, **components/**, **lib/types.ts**, **lib/schemas.ts**, **lib/services/matching.ts** and **lib/services/workflows.ts**. Package requirements come from the web and mobile package files.

The supplied LouFind logo is used as provided. The desktop illustration on page 4 is an actual project screenshot. People, IDs, item reports and pickup workflows in the demo are fictional; sample item photographs are generated illustrations, not evidence of recovered possessions.

Official external references

Saint Louis University, Philippines - Campuses

Confirms the Philippine university and its Baguio campus identity. It does not establish a relationship with LouFind.
<https://www.slu.edu.ph/campuses/>

Expo Go - Philippine App Store

The official download page used by the QR on page 10.
<https://apps.apple.com/ph/app/expo-go/id982107779>

Expo - Project / Expo Go version mismatch

Explains why the project SDK and installed Expo Go client must be compatible.
<https://docs.expo.dev/troubleshooting/expo-go-version-mismatch/>

Apple - Turn a website into an app in Safari on iPhone

Explains the Safari Share and Add to Home Screen route.
<https://support.apple.com/en-nz/guide/iphone/iphea86e5236/ios>

External pages checked on 28 August 2026. Links in this PDF are clickable.

Three things to remember

Describe clearly. Keep unique marks out of public descriptions and photos.

Verify before returning. A possible match or approval does not replace the handover check.

Know where your data lives. This demo stays in the browser or device where you used it.

For everyday use: Report, Browse, My reports and More are your starting points. If you lose your place, go back to Home or open Help & how it works.